

The State of Async Work

A 2026 field guide

Research desk — 2026

Remote-first hiring has **doubled since 2020**, and written-first culture is now the default for distributed teams¹.

Why it works

- Deep-work hours rise when meetings fall
- Decisions become searchable, not ephemeral
- Time zones stop being a constraint

Teams that default to async report 24% more deep-work hours.

Adoption

Year	Async-first teams	Change
2024	31%	-
2025	44%	+13pts
2026	58%	+14pts

Share of surveyed engineering orgs

Sources

1. Future of Work 2026 — Gartner, <https://example.com/future-of-work>